

Deal 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ T 5
 ♥ A K Q J 4 3
 ♦ J 5 3 2
 ♣ 3

14
 11 10
 5

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 3

♥ T 6

♦ Q T 8 4

♣ A K J T 7

West

1 ♥

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that

North

1 ♠

East

South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 1

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to

the punch by opening 1

♥

.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit

and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually

the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

Deal 2

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 2
♥ T 5 2
♦ K Q 4
♣ K J 6

14
11 14
1

♠ T
♥ A K Q 9 6 4
♦ J 9
♣ A 9 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5 3
♥ J 3
♦ T 8 5 3 2
♣ T 8 7

♠ A K J 7 4
♥ 8 7
♦ A 7 6
♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠	
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 2

EAST has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch,

so he overcalls 1 ♠.

WEST has 11 points, and if EAST had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to

pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

EAST actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Deal 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 5 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ Q J T 8 3
♣ 7 3

12
5 14
9

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

N
W E
S

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

♠ 8
♥ A K J 9 3
♦ 5 4 2
♣ A Q T 9

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 3

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens

1

♥

SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit

and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♠

1♥

1♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't

Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be

minimum type hand by passing.

Deal 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A T 5 3
 ♥ T 7 5
 ♦ Q 8
 ♣ A 8 6 2

11
 10 15
 4

West

2 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

♠ Q J 7 4
 ♥ A K 9 8 3 2
 ♦ 4
 ♣ J 9



♠ 2
 ♥ Q J 6
 ♦ J T 9 6 5 2
 ♣ T 4 3

North

1 ♥

Pass

East

Dbl

4 ♠

South

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 4

EAST has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit

partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

WEST needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise EAST of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

EAST's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with

♠s he bids 4 ♠.

Deal 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9
 ♥ K 8 5
 ♦ A T 9 7 5
 ♣ Q T 3

1
 12 13
 14

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8



♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

♠ A Q J T 8

♥ Q T 9

♦ 3 2

♣ A 6 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by North

1♠

Dbl

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 5

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in

each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the

opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Deal 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q T 5
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ 4 2

1
 14 13
 12

♠ 4 3

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ T 8 7

♣ J T 6 5



♠ K 6 2

♥ A 8 4

♦ 6 4 2

♣ K Q 9 7

♠ A J T 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

West

North

East

South

Dbl

2♥

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

♥

Pass

Pass

2♣

2♠

1♣

Pass

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 6

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits WEST makes a Takeout Double.

EAST has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising WEST of EAST's opening

hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

WEST suggests

♥

s as trumps.

EAST doesn't like

s so she suggests ♠s.

WEST agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

Deal 7

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ K Q J 8 4 3
 ♦ 7 6
 ♣ K Q J 4

8
 12 4
 16

♠ Q 7 4
 ♥ 9 6 5 2
 ♦ Q 5
 ♣ A 8 6 3

N
 W E
 S

♠ A K J 9 8 3
 ♥ 7
 ♦ A K J 3
 ♣ 7 5

♠ T 6 2
 ♥ A T
 ♦ T 9 8 4 2
 ♣ T 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 7

WEST's 1



opening is passed around to SOUTH. He is

tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall.

Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit,

he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

Deal 8

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 9
♥ K Q 8
♦ Q 7 4
♣ A Q 8 5

0
18 11
11

♠ T 6 3
♥ T 5 3 2
♦ T 3
♣ T 7 4 2



♠ K Q 5 4 2
♥ J 4
♦ K J 9 8 5
♣ J

♠ 8 7
♥ A 9 7 6
♦ A 6 2
♣ K 9 6 3

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	1♠
2♦	Pass	3NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 8

WEST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT.

For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

EAST bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When WEST denies holding

a 4-card Major EAST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper

since WEST promised he had the suit controlled.

Deal 9

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 4
♥ A 9 3
♦ K Q 5 4 3 2
♣ A T 7

20
13 5
2

♠ A 8 6
♥ K Q J
♦ A J 9 7
♣ K Q 4



♠ J T 5 2
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ 8 6
♣ J 8 6

♠ K Q 9 7 3
♥ T 8 5
♦ T
♣ 9 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 9

NORTH has 20 points, excellent



stoppers and a balanced hand.

She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT.
Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is
forced to bid he says 1 ♠, assuming NORTH
wants

to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced
19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

Deal 10

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ K J 6 2
♥ 6 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ 9 8 7 4

11
10 19
0

♠ A 3
♥ K J 8 7 3 2
♦ 8 4
♣ Q J T



♠ T 9 8 5
♥ 9 4
♦ T 9 6 2
♣ 5 3 2

♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q T
♦ K J 7 5
♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Dbl	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 10

EAST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in



s.

He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

WEST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2 ♠.

In theory EAST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well

go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

Deal 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ K T 8 6

13
 4 11
 12

♠ K J 4 2
 ♥ A 8 5
 ♦ K J 3 2
 ♣ J 2



♠ A Q T 5 3
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ Q T
 ♣ A 9 7 4

♠ -
 ♥ K Q T 7 3
 ♦ A 9 8 7 5
 ♣ Q 5 3

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 11

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough

to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4♠.

Deal 12

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 9 5

14
11 13
2

♠ A 8 2
♥ A 3
♦ K J T 4
♣ Q 8 6 4



♠ T 9 7 5
♥ 2
♦ Q 9 8 7 3
♣ T 7 2

♠ K J 6 4
♥ J T 7 5
♦ 6
♣ A K J 3

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Dbl	Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West
EAST passes happily.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 12

EAST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1

♦

. But what it lacks

in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

WEST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4

♥

.

Deal 13

East Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 8 3 2
♥ 9 8 6 3
♦ T 2
♣ 9 8 5

9
2 11
18

♠ J 7 6
♥ T 5 2
♦ A J 9 4
♣ K T 2



♠ A T 9 4
♥ K Q J 7
♦ Q 6
♣ A Q 4

♠ K 5
♥ A 4
♦ K 8 7 5 3
♣ J 7 6 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			



s are covered,

so she bids 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 13

SOUTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits.

This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

NORTH has good strength in EAST's



suit, probably two stoppers.

He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own.
This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

SOUTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the

Deal 14

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ Q 5
♦ K 7 4
♣ J T 7

0
13 14
13

♠ 7 5 3 2
♥ 8 4
♦ T 3 2
♣ 6 5 4 2



♠ J T
♥ K T 7 6 3
♦ Q 9 8 5
♣ A K

♠ Q 8
♥ A J 9 2
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 9 8 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2NT	1 ♥
3NT			Pass
All Pass			

3NT by East
might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid,

he happily bids 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 14

WEST has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But SOUTH beat him to the punch,

so he overcalls 1 ♠.

EAST also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an

excellent stopper in



s.

She jumps to 2NT, inviting WEST to bid game.

Since WEST has several points more than he

Deal 15

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 5
 ♥ 8 6
 ♦ T 9 7 6 4 2
 ♣ 7 3 2

14
 0 11
 15

♠ A 9 3
 ♥ J T 5 3
 ♦ Q 5
 ♣ A K 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7
 ♥ K Q 9 7
 ♦ A K 8 3
 ♣ Q J 4

♠ K Q J 6 4 2
 ♥ A 4 2
 ♦ J
 ♣ T 9 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South
 ♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 15

SOUTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, NORTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information

to SOUTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3

♥

. That

makes it easy for NORTH - he bids 4

Deal 16

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 6 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ J 7 2

♣ A 8

5

16 8

11

♠ T 8

♥ T 4 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ J T 5 4 3



♠ 9 3

♥ K Q J 9 6

♦ T 9 5 4

♣ K Q

♠ K 7 5

♥ 8 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 9 7 6 2

West

North

East

South

Dbl

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 16

There is only one reason that WEST should not overcall with 1♠. He is too strong.

The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So WEST doubles, and after EAST bids 2♣, WEST bids 2♠. This shows an overcall

type hand, but with 17 or more points.

EAST has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4♠.

Deal 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ Q 8
 ♦ A J T 8 3 2
 ♣ T 4

13
 11 1
 15

♠ K 9 8 3
 ♥ 7 6
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A J 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 2
 ♥ A K 4 3
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ K Q 8 2

♠ T 7 5
 ♥ J T 9 5 2
 ♦ 9 6
 ♣ 9 5 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 17

NORTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1

♦

.

SOUTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

NORTH now cue-bids

♦

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
 suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows her ♠ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows his ♣ suit, NORTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5 ♣.

♥

Deal 18

East Deals
None Vul

♠ 8
♥ K J T 9 4
♦ T 9
♣ A 8 7 4 3

6
8 13
13

♠ 9 6
♥ Q 6 5
♦ J 7 5 4
♣ K T 6 2



♠ A J T 7 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 5

♠ K Q 5 3 2
♥ 8 2
♦ K Q 3 2
♣ Q J

West

North

East
1 ♠

South

All Pass

1 ♠ by East

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 18

SOUTH would have had a great opening 1 ♠ bid. But when EAST opened 1 ♠

in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT

and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

Deal 19

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T
 ♥ A T 8 3
 ♦ J T 7 5 2
 ♣ K J T

8
 9 15
 8

♠ A 8 2
 ♥ J 5 2
 ♦ K 9 8 6
 ♣ 7 5 3



♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q 3
 ♣ 6 2

♠ 6 4
 ♥ K Q 9 6
 ♦ A 4
 ♣ A Q 9 8 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 19

If East had passed, SOUTH would have opened with a preemptive 3 ♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it

for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

NORTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall.

In this case, NORTH passes.

Deal 20

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J T 8 5
♥ 6 3
♦ A J T 8 5
♣ 3

7
10 6
17

♠ Q 9 6 3

♥ K T 7 2

♦ 9 2

♣ Q 7 2



♠ 4

♥ A 9 8

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ A K J T 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ Q J 5 4
♦ 6 3
♣ 9 8 6 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by West

1 ♣

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 20

WEST has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a

right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That

leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after WEST overcalls 1 ♠, that later possibility never happens because

everybody should pass.

Deal 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

17
4 12
7

♠ K J T 7 4 2

♥ A 9

♦ T 6

♣ A K Q



♠ 9

♥ K J T 7 5

♦ Q J 7 5

♣ T 9 3

♠ A 5 3

♥ 4 2

♦ A K 2

♣ J 7 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 21

EAST has 13 points but she has to pass.

She cannot Double without support for



s.

She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points.

She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And WEST of course must also pass.

Deal 22

East Deals
None Vul

♠ -
♥ T 9 4 3
♦ 6 4 3 2
♣ K J T 9 4

14
4 12
10

♠ T 3
♥ K J 7 6
♦ K J 5
♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 8 4 2
♥ Q 2
♦ Q 8 7
♣ 8 3

♠ A 9 7 6 5
♥ A 8 5
♦ A T 9
♣ 6 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
Pass	Dbl		
All Pass			
1 ♠ by East			
Penalty Double.			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 22

SOUTH obviously has to pass when EAST opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes SOUTH will name a suit and they can just

play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time

when you don't. SOUTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a

Deal 23

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 6
♥ 7 4 3
♦ J T 3
♣ J T 9 8 3

16
2 11
11

♠ Q J 5
♥ A K Q 2
♦ A 9 8 5
♣ 4 2



♠ A K 8 7 2
♥ J 9 8
♦ K 7 6
♣ 6 5

♠ 9 4 3
♥ T 6 5
♦ Q 4 2
♣ A K Q 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 23

SOUTH has a normal overcall of 1♠.

NORTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since SOUTH will

not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks SOUTH can make, 4♠.

Deal 24

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 6 5
♥ 8 4
♦ K J T 3
♣ A J 8 4

11
9 11
9

♠ A J 7 2
♥ T 9
♦ A Q 7 2
♣ 7 3 2

N
W E
S

♠ 9 8 4
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ 8 4
♣ K Q 9 5

♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ T 6

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	1 ♥	Pass
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 24

EAST has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1

♥

.

WEST has 9 points with a good

♦

stopper. She bids 1NT.

EAST has nothing more to say, and lets WEST play 1NT.